

FREE SAMPLE

White's Tree Frog Care Package

The first 4 pages of the 42-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview. The contents page shows every one of the 42 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 38 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/whites-tree-frog/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free White's tree frog care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/whites-tree-frog/, and stays free.

CONTENTS

What's inside

Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

GETTING STARTED

How to Use This Package	3
-------------------------	---

SECTION 01 · PROFILE

Quick Profile & Cost Overview	4
-------------------------------	---

SECTION 02 · HOUSING & ENVIRONMENT

The Vertical Enclosure & Where It Goes	5
The Temperature Gradient & Heating	6
The Humidity Cycle That Dips	7
The Water That Is Safe to Mist With	8
Ultraviolet B (UVB) Light & the Day Length	9
Substrate, Plants & Furnishings	10
Cleaning Without Soap, and Household Chemicals	11

SECTION 03 · FEEDING

Feeding by Size & Age	12
Feeder Insects, Treats & Supplements	13
Body Condition: Reading the Tympanum Ridges	14

SECTION 04 · HANDLING & BEHAVIOR

Handling With Plain Water & No Soap	15
Shedding, Color, Calling & Normal Behavior	16
Common Mistakes & Enrichment	17

SECTION 05 · ARRIVAL & LIFE STAGES

Choosing a Frog, Quarantine & the Law	18
Group Housing by Size, Sexing & Breeding	19

SECTION 06 · HEALTH & COMMON ISSUES

Health Red Flags & Finding a Vet	20
Obesity, Fatty Eyes & Fatty Liver	21
Chytridiomycosis	22
Red-Leg Syndrome & Bacterial Infection	23
Metabolic Bone Disease & Vitamin A	24
Skin Injuries, Chemical Exposure & Dehydration	25
Impaction, Parasites & Shedding Problems	26

SECTION 07 · QUICK REFERENCE

Setup Checklist & Targets	27
Emergency & Quick Targets Card	28

SECTION 08 · OWNER TOOLS

Budget: Setup & Shopping List	29
Budget: Yearly Costs	30
First 30 Days	31
Symptom Quick Reference	32
Daily, Weekly & Seasonal Routine	33
Power Outages, Heat Waves, Travel & Transport	34
Pet-Sitter Sheet	35
Owner Log	36
Equipment & Vet Log	37

REFERENCE

Glossary, A to H	38
Glossary, I to Z	39
Sources	40
Where the Sources Disagree	41
Version History & About	42

START HERE

How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

UNITS USED THROUGHOUT

Every temperature and size is given twice. Temperatures appear in degrees Fahrenheit (°F) with degrees Celsius (°C) beside them. Sizes appear in inches (in) with centimeters (cm) beside them. The one liquid measure is milliliters (mL), per liter of water. Humidity is a percentage (%) of the moisture the air could hold. Prices are in United States dollars.

If you haven't bought a frog yet

Read pages 4 through 11 in order before buying anything, then the feeding section. Two decisions are the expensive ones to get wrong: the enclosure on page 5, which has to be tall rather than long, and how many frogs you keep on page 19, because when two frogs differ in size, the bigger one may try to swallow the smaller. Settle both, then use the Budget and Shopping List on page 29 to buy once instead of twice.

If your frog is already home

Start with the Setup Checklist on page 27 to audit what you have. Then read page 8 before you next fill the mister, because untreated tap water and distilled water are both wrong for an animal that drinks and breathes through its skin. Then page 14: obesity is the most common problem in captive adults of this species, and the check takes seconds. If anything already looks wrong, go straight to Health Red Flags on page 20.

Print these first

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Page 27: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 35: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
| ☐ Page 28: Emergency & Quick Targets Card | ☐ Page 36: Owner Log |
| ☐ Page 32: Symptom Quick Reference | ☐ Page 37: Equipment & Vet Log |
| ☐ Page 33: Daily, Weekly & Seasonal Routine | ☐ Page 14: Body Condition |

WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

The White's tree frog is sold as the easy frog, and next to most amphibians it is: calm, sturdy, and one of the few that tolerates being picked up. The trouble is that its easiness gets read as low maintenance. A frog that eats everything offered gets fed everything, advice to keep humidity high gets followed with an enclosure that never dries, and tap water goes into the mister because it is what comes out of the faucet. Each of those is a common way this species gets sick. Every figure here is cross-checked against the veterinary and scientific sources listed on page 40, and every temperature and dimension is given in both imperial and metric.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

A veterinarian who sees amphibians. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care, and anything urgent is a professional call, not a page in this book. Amphibian medicine has real limits, which puts most of the weight on getting the setup right, and it also means the vet you need is not the nearest one. Find one before you need one, and write the number on page 28.

Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

Scientific name	<i>Litoria caerulea</i> . Also called the dumpy tree frog or Australian green tree frog. It is also filed under the newer name <i>Ranoidea caerulea</i>
Native range	Northern and eastern Australia and southern New Guinea. Forest and woodland, and often around houses, where lit windows draw insects
Adult size	3 to 4.5 in (7 to 11 cm). Females run larger: about 4 in (10 cm) against a male's 3 in (7.5 cm)
Captive lifespan	About 16 years on average, with one recorded at 21 in human care. More conservative estimates are 10 to 15-plus. Plan on well over a decade
Activity	Nocturnal. Sleeps through the day tucked against cover and hunts in the evening
Diet	Live insects. Crickets as the staple, juveniles fed daily, adults 2 to 3 times a week. Page 12
Enclosure, one adult	18×18×24 in (46×46×61 cm), the 24 in being height. 24×18×24 in (61×46×61 cm) for two to four of a similar size
Temperature	Cool side 70 to 75°F (21 to 24°C), basking area 80 to 85°F (27 to 29°C), mid-70s°F (about 24°C) at night
Humidity	50 to 60% baseline, misted up to 70 to 80% once or twice a day, then allowed to fall. Page 7
Water	Dechlorinated tap or spring water. Never distilled or reverse-osmosis (RO) water. Page 8
UVB	UVB (ultraviolet B) is the band of ultraviolet light a frog uses to make vitamin D3. Recommended rather than required: a 5% UVB T5 HO tube, replaced every 6 to 8 months. T5 is the slim fluorescent kind, 5/8 inch across; HO, high output, is the tube format; the 5% rating is what keeps it gentle. Page 9
Signature risk	Obesity. Read it off the ridges above the eardrum, not the waistline. Page 14
Handling	Tolerated, unusually for a frog. Plain water on your hands, no soap, 5 to 15 minutes, about twice a week at most
Conservation status	Least Concern on the IUCN Red List, the global list of species at risk kept by the International Union for Conservation of Nature. Buy captive-bred

Cost overview

Initial setup

The frog is \$20 to \$60 for a standard animal, more for a blue or other designer color. Itemized, the setup with its first supplements comes to **\$305 to \$595**, and the terrarium is the biggest single line. With the frog and a first vet exam, plan on **\$375 to \$805**. Page 29 has every line.

Ongoing

Feeders, supplements, UVB tubes and water conditioner run **\$150 to \$245 a year**, about \$10 to \$25 a month, with substrate and a little electricity on top. An exam is \$50 to \$150, and an exotic emergency fee alone often starts around \$250 before any treatment.

THE NUMBER THAT SHOULD DRIVE THE DECISION

Not the price. The lifespan. A frog bought for a twelve-year-old is very likely still alive when that child is finishing college. The purchase is the cheap part of this animal, and the routine on page 33 is what you are actually signing up for.